

How to read a spec sheet.

The five figures worth checking before you sign off a window.

The five figures

Check these first.

/01 **Design pressure**

Wind load the window is rated for, in psf. Higher is stronger.

/02 **U-factor**

Heat through the whole window. Lower is better.

/03 **STC**

Sound blocked. Higher is quieter.

/04 **Air infiltration**

Air leaking through, in cfm/ft². Lower is tighter.

/05 **Water resistance**

Pressure before water gets in, in psf. Higher is better.

An example

Vista Guard, on paper.

Design pressure

± 65 psf

Air infiltration

0.002 cfm/ft²

Water resistance

15 psf

Impact

Wind Zone 4

Approval

HVHZ

A photograph showing a wooden mallet striking a window pane, causing a large, star-shaped crack pattern to spread across the glass. The window is set in a dark frame.

● Impact test

And one more

On the coast, check impact.

- /01 Large or small missile.
- /02 Wind Zone rating.
- /03 Approved inside or outside the HVHZ.

Look for

**Florida Product Approval or
NOA**

Save this

Five numbers, one decision.

Send us any spec sheet and we will walk you through it.

Which number do you check first? Tell us in the comments.

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